

Day of Data Baton Rouge 2026

PowerShell + AI Enhancement not a Replacement

James Petty

NO FOOD OR DRINKS IN THE CLASSROOMS

Day of Data Baton Rouge 2026



Thank You, Sponsors!

James Petty

IT Director , #HireMe

7x Azure / PowerShell MVP

Lead Author

- Learn PowerShell in a Month of Lunches
- Learn PowerShell Scripting in a Month of Lunches

@PSJamesP on most socials

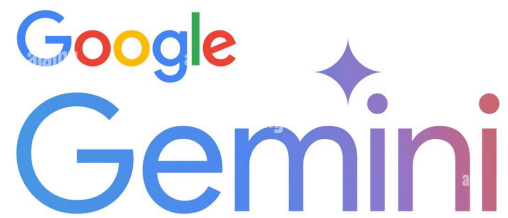




<https://bsky.app/profile/psjamesp.dev>

[**github.com/psjamesp/dayofdatabr26**](https://github.com/psjamesp/dayofdatabr26)





The AI Trap

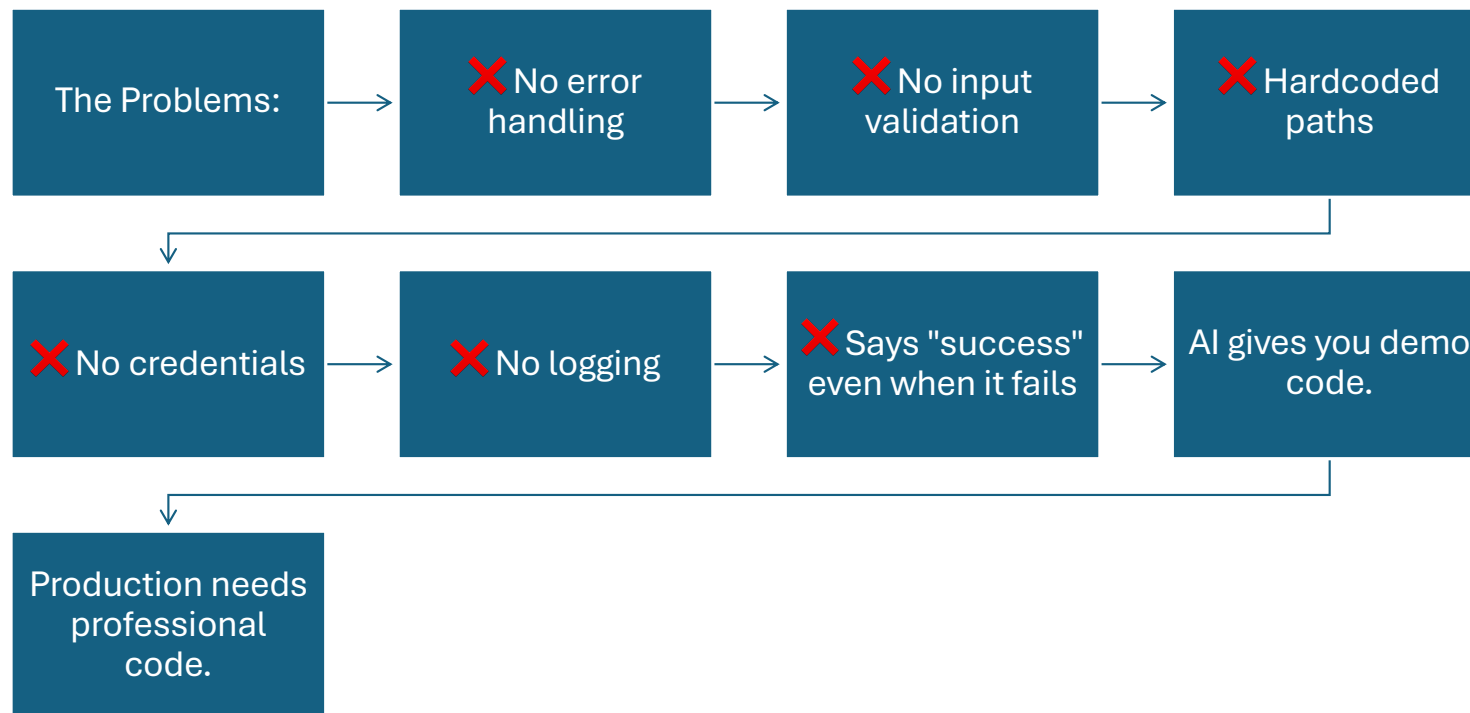
LIVE DEMO

Simple Prompt:

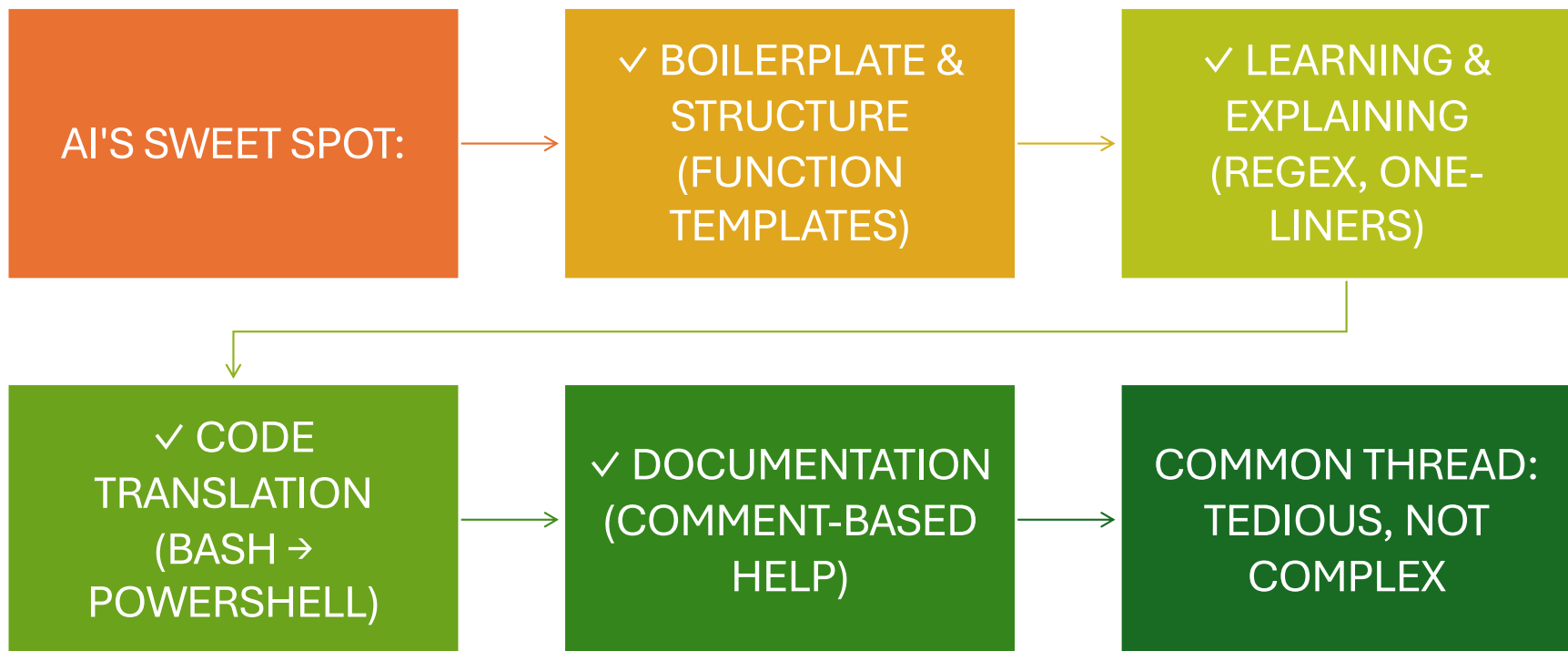
"Write a PowerShell script that asks for a computer name and copies a log file from it"

Watch what happens...

What's Actually Wrong



Where AI Actually Helps



Where AI Fails Hard



AI Doesn't Know:



- Your environment or policies



- Security best practices



- How to handle errors properly



- What "production ready" means



Result: Fast, dangerous code

Security Disaster

LIVE DEMO

"Write a script to connect to SQL Server"

Let's see the security nightmare...

The Knowledge Gap

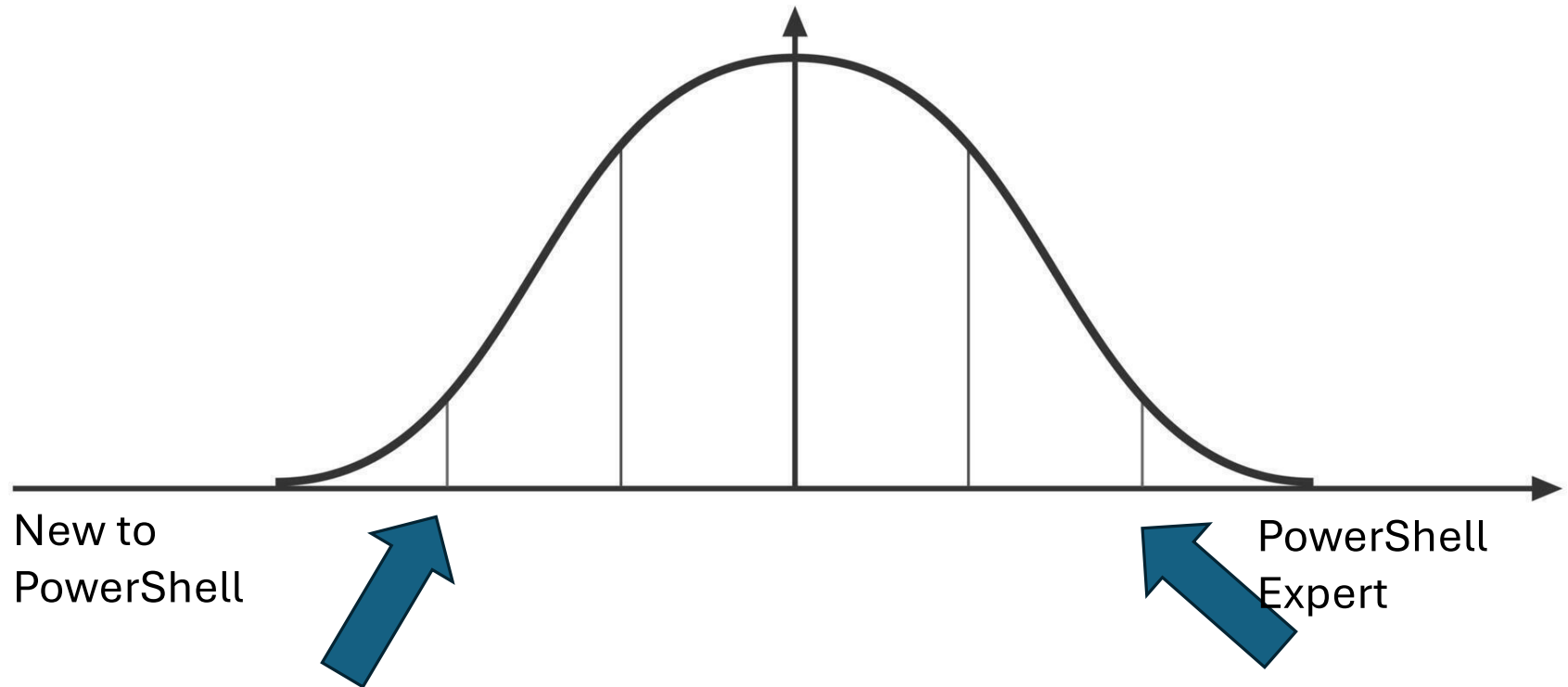
The Growing Problem:

Junior admins who CAN'T:

- Debug their own code
- Understand what it does
- Fix it when it breaks
- Work without AI

They generate code. They don't DO PowerShell.

AI Efficiency and PowerShell





Story time

Story 1: Production Outage

- - AI cleanup script deployed without testing
- - Deleted live database files
- - 6 hours recovery, \$250K downtime
- - "But AI said it was right..."

Story 2: The Interview

- - Impressive AI-generated GitHub
- - Couldn't explain basic concepts
- - No foundational knowledge

Story 3: The Expert

- - 15 years experience
 - - Over-relied on AI for "efficiency"
 - - Skills atrophied in 6 months
- 

Choose your Path

Path A: AI-Dependent

Fast output

Shallow knowledge

Can't work without AI

Hits ceiling quickly

Replaceable

Path B: Augmented

Thoughtful + Fast

Deep expertise

AI enhances skills

Continuous growth

Hard to Replace

Warning Signs

Are You Too Dependent?

✗ Can't start coding without AI

✗ Anxious without AI access

✗ Can't explain your own code

✗ Need AI to debug AI code

✗ Forgot cmdlets you used to know

If you checked 3+, you have a problem.

Writing Better Prompts

Bad Prompt:

"Write a script to delete old log files"

Good Prompt:

"Create PowerShell function that removes files older than X days from specified directory.

Include: parameter validation, -WhatIf, try/catch error handling, logging, return objects, comment-based help.

Target: Windows Server 2019+"

Specificity = Quality

The AI Trap

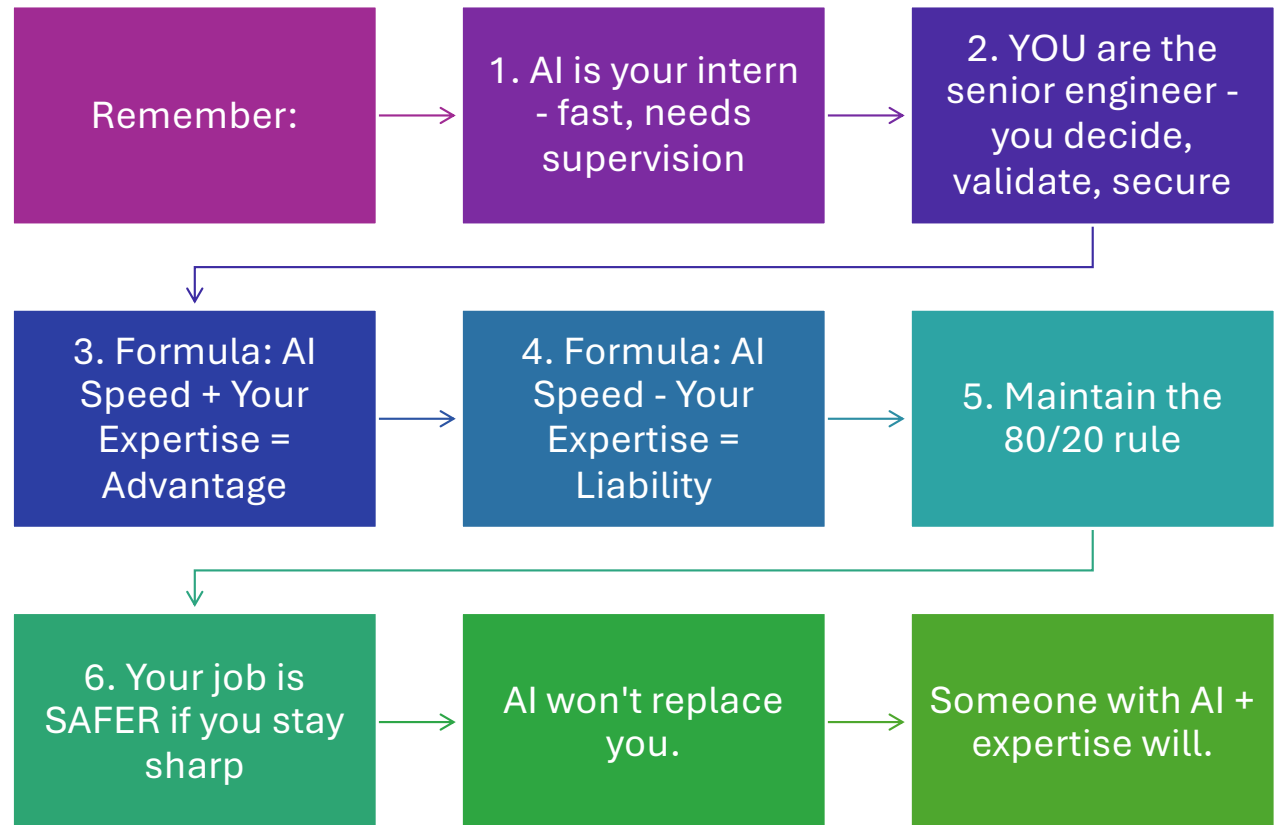
LIVE DEMO

Simple Prompt:

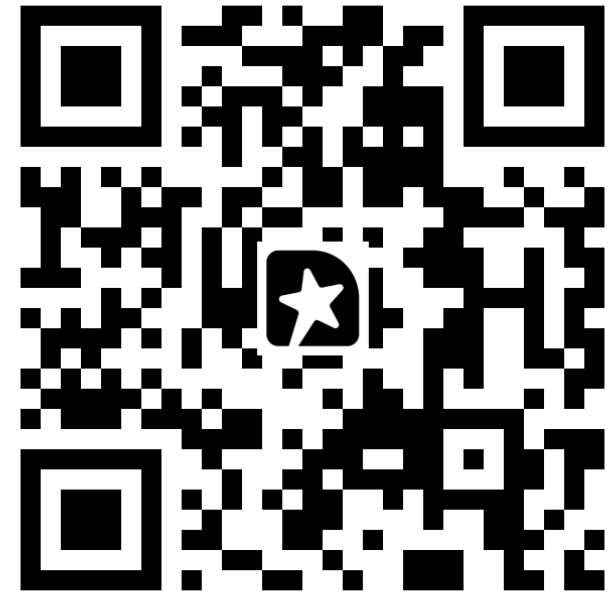
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Key Takeaways



Please complete your session evaluations



PowerShell + AI: Enhancement, Not Replacement

